

Introduction to the Unit

In this unit, you will be introduced with the Constitution in general, its major types, strengths and weakness of unwritten Constitution and the 1973 Constitution of Islamic Republic of Pakistan in particular. You will study about volunteers and their contribution in the society. This unit also describes the role of civil society organization to the welfare of the citizens and how they advocate for the rights of vulnerable people of society.

CHAPTER :1 THE CONSTITUTION**SLOs:**

- Define the term Constitution.
- Identify the purpose (e.g. empower the state, establish unifying values and goals, provide government stability, protect rights and freedoms and legitimize regimes) of having a constitution.
- Differentiate between written and unwritten constitutions.
- List the strengths and weaknesses of a written constitution.
- Identify the components of the constitution of Pakistan.
- Identify the key ideas and principles in the constitution of Pakistan (eg. separation of powers, rule of law, representative government, sovereignty and fundamental rights).
- Examine how the constitution promotes the equality of citizens (Identify relevant articles).
- Identify how the constitution protects the liberty of citizens (identifying relevant articles).
- Describe the functions and powers of Supreme Court under 1973 constitutions.
- Highlight the role of Supreme Court in providing fundamental rights of people of Pakistan.

Introduction

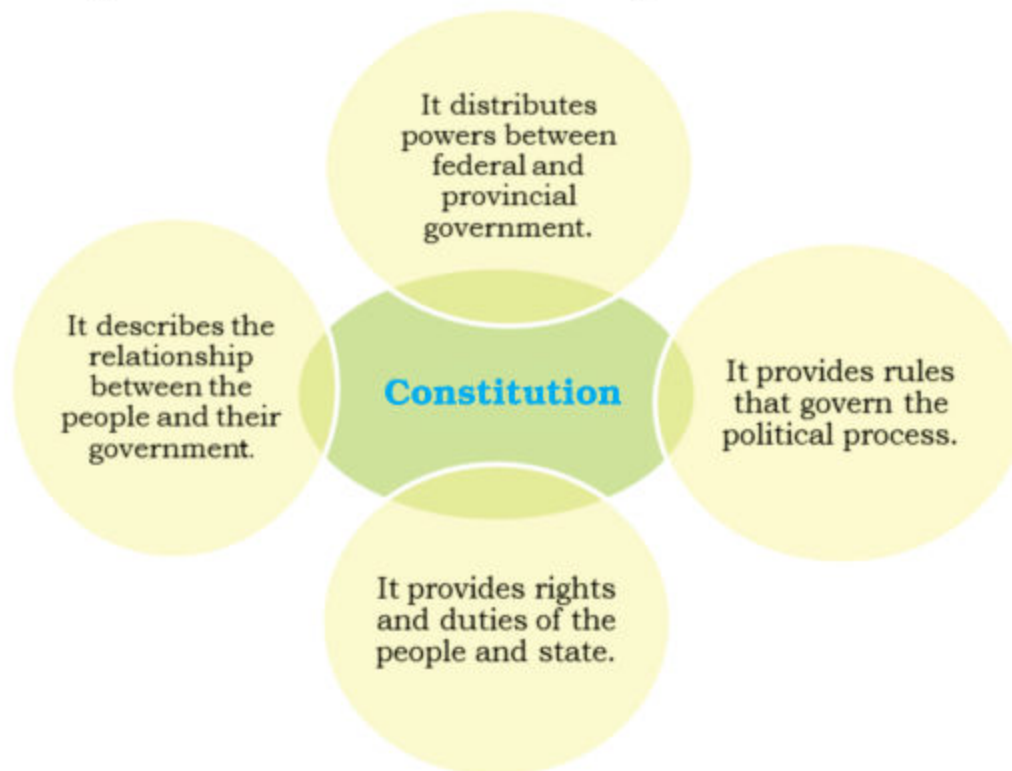
This chapter mainly focuses on the constitution in its broader way and the Constitution of Pakistan 1973. You will also study equality and the liberty of citizens which is propagated by the constitution.

The Constitution

It is a basic and fundamental law of a state. It sets out how the state will be organized. It is a body of rules established to regulate the system of government within a state. It is the supreme law of state which lays down rules regarding organization, powers and functions of the government.

Functions of the Constitution

Primarily, the constitution serves following functions:



Each and every democratic country has a constitution. It is a vital document, according to which the country carries out its operations. Constitution protects the rights of the citizens irrespective of religion, caste and creed. Thus, it can be said a constitution is a social contract between the government and the people.

Activity

A constitution serves a number of functions in a state. Keeping in view the importance and functions of constitution, work together in groups and find out other functions of the constitutions.

Teacher's Note

The teachers should guide students in finding out functions of the constitution by engaging them in a debate.

Types of Constitution

There are many types of constitution, but here we will discuss about the written and unwritten constitution only. The following table (On next page) will help you to understand the difference between them:

Written Constitution	Unwritten Constitution
It is written in the form of a book or document. It consisted of procedures. For example, the constitution of USA.	It is not written in the form of a book or document. It is consisted of conventions. For example, the British constitution.
It is made and enacted by a constituent assembly of the people	This type of constitution is the result of a gradual process of constitutional evolution.
It is rigid in nature.	It is flexible in nature.
A written constitution is definite. Its provisions can be quoted in for and against any power exercised by the government	An unwritten constitution cannot be produced as evidence. It can be proved by quoting its sources and practices.

However, there are following strengths and weaknesses of the **written constitution**:

Strengths	Weakness
1. The written constitution is very clear and precise. It is free from doubts and ambiguity. 2. A constitution lays emphasis on the supremacy of rule of law. 3. It is indispensable to federalism. It distributes powers between the centre and federating units - states or provinces. 4. It protects the fundamental rights of the individual. 5. It protects the interests of minorities. 6. It defines the functions of three branches of government. 7. As a written constitution is clear, the ruler (government) cannot exercise powers arbitrarily. And, it also prevents the governments from exercising the powers arbitrarily.	1. The written constitution cannot be changed or modified due its rigidity. 2. It can cause frustration and anger among people under the circumstances in which constitution does not change according to the needs of society. 3. It is believed that written constitution attaches more importance to written laws. As a result, the importance of public opinion decreases. 4. It does not give much importance to the conventions.

Activity

Conduct an interview of Headmaster/ Journalist or a lawyer about the importance of constitution.

Teacher's Note

The teacher should help students to prepare a list of relevant questions that can serve the purpose of above activity.

Features/Components of the Constitution of Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973

Written Constitution: Constitution of Pakistan 1973 is a written constitution. It comprises of 280 Articles. It also contains 6 schedules, which has been divided into 12 parts and so far 23 amendments have been made in it.

State Religion: According to the constitution of Pakistan 1973, Islam is the state religion.

National Language and Official Language: In the constitution, Urdu is declared as National Language but the official language is English.

Federal Form of Government: Constitution of Pakistan 1973 provides federal form of government. Federation is consisting of four provinces and a federal capital.

Parliamentary form of Government: It means the elected representative of the people administer the country.

Direct Elections: Constitution of Pakistan 1973 has provided method of direct elections to elect members of National Assembly and Provincial Assembly.

Bi-Cameral Legislature: The Federal Legislature is bi-cameral consisting two houses i.e Senate (upper house) and National Assembly (lower House).

Independence of Judiciary: An Independent Judiciary has been provided in 1973 constitution. Judiciary safeguards the fundamental rights of the people of Pakistan.

Rights of Minorities: Rights of Minorities have been protected in the 1973 constitution.

Key Principles of The Constitution of Pakistan

Separation of Powers

The constitution of Pakistan 1973 provides for separation of powers between three branches of government. These powers are exercised by three branches of government: Executive, Legislature and Judiciary.

Rule of Law and Fundamental Rights

According to Dicey's concept of Rule of Law, no one is above the law. The constitution of Pakistan recognizes that all citizens are equal before

the law and are entitled to equal protection of law. To fulfill this objective, constitution of Pakistan has provided some fundamental rights. These fundamental rights include equality of status, equal opportunity to access law, social, economic and political justice. It further includes freedom of thought, expression, belief, faith, worship and association, subject to law and public morality.

Activity

Describe how the constitution of Pakistan promotes the equality of citizens. Find out relevant articles addressing equality of citizen and share with your class fellows.

Teacher's Note

The teacher should help students in finding out the relevant articles by providing them the document of 1973 constitution and engage them in a debate about the rights guaranteed.

Sovereignty and Representative Government

Sovereignty means supreme authority. Sovereign is one who does not share his authority and his commands cannot be challenged. According to 1973 constitution, Pakistan is a sovereign state. It exercises its powers through elected representatives of the people. The representative government is consisted of three branches i.e Executive, Legislature and Judiciary.

Activity

Divide into groups and collect information from the news papers regarding human rights issues that Supreme/ High Court have addressed in recent years and present it before the class.

SUMMARY

In this chapter, you studied about the Constitution which is called the supreme law of the land. People get their rights protected from the constitution. You were introduced that there are two types of constitution i.e Written and Unwritten. You also studied about the describing features of 1973 constitution and its key principles were also discussed in detail.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

Check your knowledge and understanding

Fill in the blanks

- i. _____ is a basic and fundamental law of a state.
- ii. The representative government is consisted of three branches i.e Executive, _____ and _____.
- iii. Sovereignty means _____.
- iv. The constitution of Pakistan comprises of _____ articles.

Answer the following questions:

- I. Explain rule of law in detail?
- II. Describe the strengths and weakness of unwritten constitution?
- III. What is sovereignty?
- IV. Identify how the constitution protects the fundamental rights including liberty of citizens? Mention related articles in support of your answer.

Cooperate with Others

Work together in groups and make a booklet of rules governing the school council.

Use your Inquiry/ Investigation Skills

Reflect on your past learning. Explore and list powers and functions of the Supreme Court and Parliament according to 1973 constitution.

Sr. No.	Supreme Court	Parliament

SLOs:

- Define the term citizen.
- Identify the rights and freedom of citizens in the Constitution of Pakistan.
- Classify rights into civil, political, social and economic.
- Identify responsibilities of citizens given in the constitution.
- Describe how in fulfilling responsibilities citizens ensure other's rights.
- Choose a right or freedom and assess the extent to which it is met in Pakistan.
- Explain how rights and freedom given in the constitution are ensured and denied through citing everyday examples.
- Describe the role of a citizen in a democratic state.
- Explain responsibilities of citizenship (e.g., initiating changes in laws or policy, holding public office, respecting the law, being informed and attentive to public issues, paying taxes, registering to vote and voting knowledgeably).
- Describe the relationship between citizenships rights and responsibilities.
- Explain why rights have limits.
- Describe ways citizens can work together to promote the values and principles of democracy.
- Evaluate oneself as a responsible citizen of Pakistan.
- Identify situations in which a citizen might not be expected to fulfill his/her responsibilities.
- Identify ways citizens can act to protect their rights.
- Define the term advocacy.
- Identify two advocacy strategies that you know and give examples of how they are used.
- Develop an advocacy strategy to advocate for a right of their choice.

Introduction

This chapter is about citizen, identifying their rights and responsibilities and focusing the role of citizens in a democratic state. The roles and responsibilities of a citizen in a democratic society are further explained with activities related to children rights and responsibilities. You will also study about the advocacy.

Who is a citizen?

A person who is a legally recognized resident of a particular country and who has rights because of being born there or a person who lives in a particular town or city is called citizen.

Activity

Ask your parents, teachers and elders that what benefits do people have in Pakistan as a result of being a citizen?

Do You Know?

1. Natural-born citizen is a citizen who was born in a state.

2. Naturalized citizen is one who has adopted the citizenship of any other state.

Classification of Rights

Broadly, the rights can be classified as follows:

Civil Rights

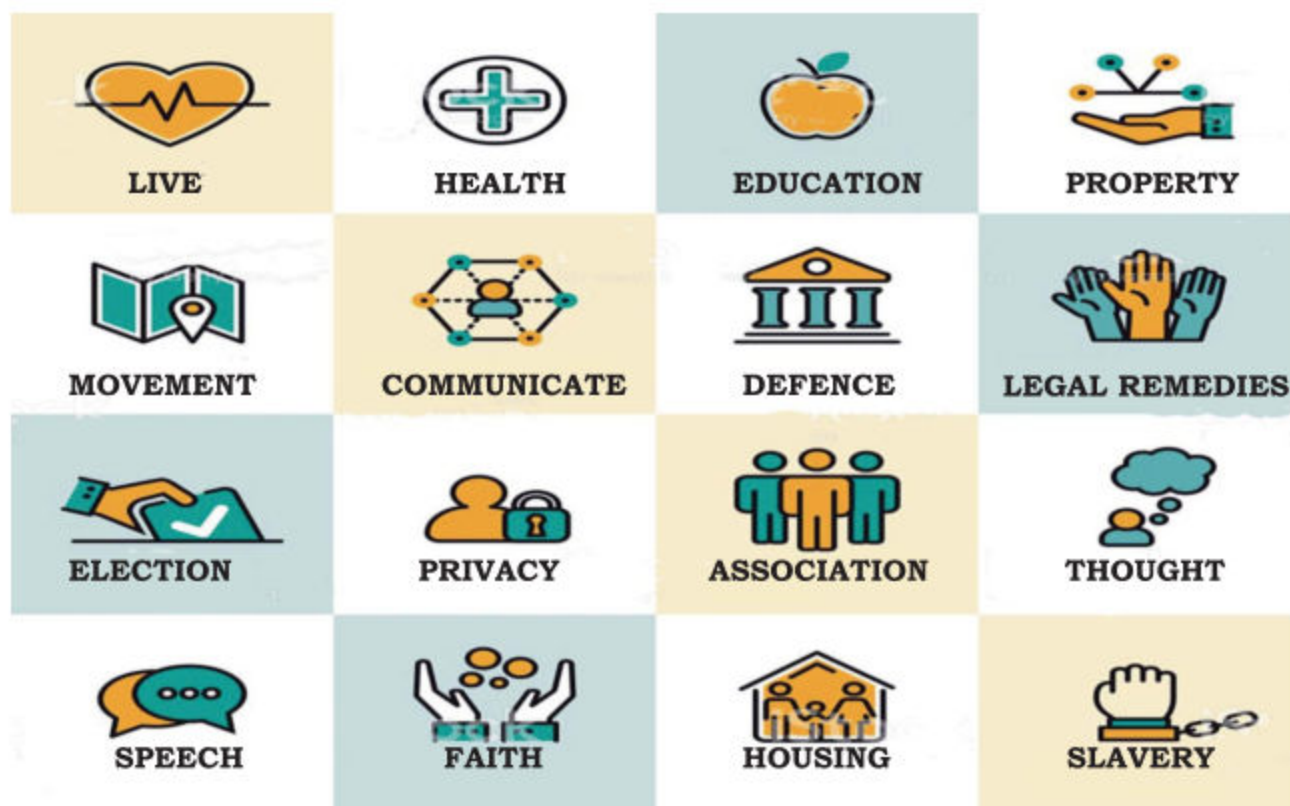
The civil rights are mainly associated with the life and liberty of a citizen. It includes security of the person and protection from physical violence, torture and inhuman treatment. Civil rights describes that no person can be arbitrary arrested and exiled. It protects citizens from illegal slavery and detention. These rights prohibits for interference in one's privacy and right of ownership. Civil rights also include restriction of one's freedom of movement and freedom of thought. These rights promote free practicing of religion.

Political Rights

Political rights include freedom of expression, freedom of association and assembly. Every citizen has the right to take part in the government and he/ she has right to vote and stand for election at the time of elections.

Economic and Social Rights

These rights provide the conditions necessary for prosperity and well being of citizens. Economic rights refer to the right to property, right to work, which a citizen freely chooses or accepts. It includes the right to fair wages and a reasonable limitation of working hours. These rights also propagate for trade union rights. Social rights are those rights which are necessary for an adequate standard of living including right to health, shelter, food, social care and the right to education.



United Nation's Universal Human Rights Declaration

The United Nations has also adopted a Universal Human Rights Declaration. The main features of this declaration are as under:

- It is called the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, adopted by the General Assembly on 10th December, 1948.
- It sets forth basic rights and fundamental freedom to which everyone is entitled, irrespective of race, sex, language or religion.
- These include the right to a nationality, the right to fair trial by an independent and impartial tribunal, the right to own property, the right to an adequate standard of living, the right to education, freedom from slavery and servitude, freedom from arbitrary arrest and detention, and freedom of thought, conscience and religion.
- The declaration is not a legal instrument (law) but it proclaims a common standard of achievement for all people and nations.

[Source: Chamber's Encyclopedia, Vol. XIV, P105]

Human rights apply to all age groups. Similarly, children have the same general human rights as adults have. In 1989, however, world leaders decided that children need a special treatment known as convention on the rights of children (CRC) because people under 18 years old often need special care and protection that adults do not need.

Activity

Select each fundamental right and write in the next column how are your rights in each area protected.

My constitutional rights as a child	I enjoy/ do not enjoy these rights (give example)
Right to survive (life, health, nutrition, name, nationality)	
Right to Develop (education, care, leisure, recreation, cultural activities)	
Right to Protect (exploitation, abuse, neglect)	
Right to Participate (to expression, information, thought, religion)	

Rights and Responsibilities of Citizens

Citizenship offers many benefits and equally important responsibilities. By fulfilling, you are demonstrating your commitment to your country. Being a good citizens, there are many responsibilities such as to live together peacefully, to respect other people and to work and struggle for the development of the country. The other responsibilities of a citizen include understanding the importance of free press, taking action against oppressive and discriminatory policies and understanding the processes of election. Below you will find several rights and responsibilities that all citizens should exercise and respect:

Rights	Responsibilities
• Freedom to express. • Freedom to worship. • Right to a justice. • Right to vote in elections. • Right to employment. • Right to run for elected office. • Freedom to pursue "life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness."	• Support and defend the Constitution. • Stay informed of the issues affecting community. • Participate in the democratic process. • Respect and obey laws. • Respect the rights, beliefs and opinions of others. • Participate in local community. • Pay income and other taxes honestly on time to federal state and local authorities. • Defend the country if needed.

Keep the country clean



Abiding by the law



Right to give vote



Save from domestic violence



Activity

The above pictures describe that how citizens are fulfilling responsibilities and ensuring the rights of others.

Give two reasons how the responsibilities can ensure rights of others.

Keep the country clean	Cast vote
1.	1.
2.	2.
3.Rule of Law	4.Save from domestic violence
1.	1.
2.	2.

Right /Freedom enjoyed by citizens in Pakistan

The Article 25-A of the 1973 Constitution of the Islamic Republic of **Pakistan** provides for free **education** to all children of age five (5) to sixteen (16) as a Fundamental **Right** and its provision is a responsibility of the State.

Do You Know?

Sindh became the first province to make a law providing free and compulsory education to all children between the ages of five and 16 years in February 2013.

Activity

Survey your neighborhood and find out how many children in your area are enjoying right to free education?

Rights and Freedom (In The Constitution) Ensured/ Denied

As a child, you have learnt about the children's rights in a democratic state. You are in a school, hence you have been given the right to education. You have a name, thus you have been given the right for identity. You also have a home to live in and a family to protect you, thus you have the right to safety and security. Do you think all children in your community enjoy all of the above rights?

Activity

In the following three situations, what rights are being denied to children? Give examples:

- i. Beggar child
- ii. A child doing labour for earning
- iii. A child suffering from a serious disease (polio)

The Role of a Citizen in a Democratic State

Pakistan is a democratic country. As a citizen, it is the responsibility of a citizen to choose a leader by casting vote. It is also the duty of a citizen to keep informing other citizens about the policies of the government. The citizen has to make sure that he contributes to the development of community in his area. You as a child can help elders. It is responsibility of citizens to respect the law of land and to be loyal to the state.

Communicating With Elected Officials

You and your elders have the right to communicate with elected officials who represent you. But, many people do not. Some people feel afraid of or do not know how to tell their elected officials what they think. You will find tips for how to:

- write a letter
- pay a visit
- make a phone call
- speak at a meeting

Why should you communicate with Your Elected Officials?

There are many reasons to communicate with your elected officials. You may want to:

- thank them for something they have done.
- ask them to take some sort of action.
- let them know how you feel about concerns such as education, crime, taxes or the environment.

Activity

Respond to each statement by writing an explanation as to why you agree or disagree.

1. A citizen is defined only by the country he or she lives in. I agree/disagree because:_____.
2. A government should treat all of its citizens equally. I agree/disagree because:_____.
3. Being a citizen means you should be responsible to your country at all times. I agree/disagree because:_____.
4. Your identification with your country is more important than your identification with a group (i.e, race, religion, ethnicity, etc.). I agree/disagree because:_____.

Rights Have Limits

Every right one have, must be balanced against someone else's right. My right to speak, my mind about a person must be balanced against someone else's right to not have their reputation ruined. My right to a resource must be balanced against everyone else's right.

Activity

In the following table, match column A with column B to complete the sentence:

Column A: Right to	Column B: Limitations
Play	From distance and with agreed timings and adults approved programmes.
Express views	They must bear similar values and are approved by our elders.
Watch television	Approved timings and apps.
IT gadgets (mobile phone, iPad, laptops)	Respect other persons sentiments and right for holding an opinion.
Choose friends	With a clear agreement for maintaining timings and the approved play /games.

Citizens Rights Are Protected

Embrace the duty to protect and promote human rights: The protection and promotion of human rights is not limited to the governments. Every person has a duty to know about his fundamental rights, promote them and respect them.

Act as a citizen to document human rights violations: If you witness a violation of any of the human rights, you can report these violations to organizations dedicated to protecting and preserving human rights for all. In order to submit a complaint about human rights violation, you must be able to document and provide the following information:

- Identify the specific article of the United Nations Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) that was violated.
- Collect all of the facts related to the human rights violation in a detailed manner and if possible, in a chronological order.
- Provide the date, time and place of the incident(s); and name, position and place of action if applicable; names and addresses of any witnesses and any other important details.

Activity

During the recess/ break at school, you observed a student of junior class being bullied by another student of the senior class. What specific actions will you take to protect his right to play?

Activity: Situations to fulfill his/her responsibilities

Identify a responsibility that comes from each of the following sources:

- Promises • Assignments • Appointments • Occupation • Laws
- Custom • Citizenship • Moral principles

Now, you are aware about the responsibilities. Give your response for each of the following;

- Which ones did you take on freely or voluntarily?
- Which were you required to assume?
- Which did you take on without conscious choice – that is, without thinking about them?
- Which two do you think are most important? Why?
- What rewards might you receive for fulfilling each of these two most important responsibilities? What penalties might you pay for failing to fulfil them?
- What is the importance of fulfilling these two responsibilities?
- What might happen if people do not fulfil such responsibilities?

Arise of Conflicts in Fulfilling Responsibilities

There are two common types of conflicts that can arise when we have to make choices about fulfilling responsibilities.

1. In some situations, two responsibilities are in conflict and there may not be a way to fulfil both of them at the same time.
2. In other situations, there is a conflict among responsibilities and other values and interests.

Activity

Suppose you attend a meeting of students in your school. The group is supposed to suggest rules for the playground. You have the right to speak and give your suggestions.

- Which responsibilities should you have in the way you speak and what you say? List and explain these responsibilities.
- What responsibilities should other students at the meeting have toward your right to speak? List and explain these responsibilities.
- What responsibilities should you have toward the other students' right to speak? List and explain these responsibilities.
- What might happen to the right to free speech if no one fulfilled the responsibilities you have discussed?

What is Advocacy?

1. Advocacy means to ensure that vulnerable people in society are able to:
 - Have their voice heard on issues that are important to them.
 - Defend and safeguard their rights.
 - Have their views and wishes genuinely considered when decisions are being made about their lives.
2. Advocacy is a process of supporting and enabling people to:
 - Express their views and concerns.
 - Access information and services.
 - Defend and promote their rights and responsibilities.
 - Explore choices and options

In short, advocacy can be defined as "a process based on verified evidence to directly and indirectly influence decision makers, stakeholders and victims to support and implement actions that contribute to the fulfillment of human rights".

The Process of Developing an Advocacy Strategy

Step 1. Objectives: What do you want?

An effective advocacy effort must begin with a clear set of objectives. This can include long-term objectives and short term objectives.

Step 2. Audiences: Who can give it to you?

Who are the people and institutions you need to move? This includes affected people and those who have the actual formal authority to deliver (i.e. public authorities) and also the other actors who will influence their decision making (the media, key constituencies and others).

Step 3. Message: What do they need to hear?

Reaching these different audiences requires framing of a set of messages that will be influential. Effective advocacy messages generally have two basic components: Why the advocacy objective is the right thing to do and why it is in the interest of the authority to do it.

Step 4. Messengers: Who do they need to hear it from?

Who are the most credible messengers for different audiences? Three kinds of messengers are important: "Neutral Experts" whose credibility is largely technical; "Authentic Voices," of the people who can speak from personal experience and "Influential People," who have some political connections that make authorities want to listen.

Step 5. Action: How best to get the message delivered?

There is a continuum of ways to deliver an advocacy message. Some are "inside strategies" in which persuasion takes place through traditional channels and meetings. Another approach is to involve "outside strategies" which aimed at changing the context in which decisions are made. The mixture of these two approaches is the right way for an advocacy. It depends on what is needed to get the job done and what the groups involved are able to do and are comfortable in doing so.

Step 6. Resources: What have we got?

An effective advocacy effort needs advocacy resources. This includes past advocacy work, previous affiliations, members and other people, information and political intelligence.

Step 7. Gaps: What do we need to develop?

The next step is to identify the advocacy resources you need. This means looking at alliances that need to be built, and capacities such as media and research which are crucial to any effort.

Step 8. First Efforts: How do we begin?

What would be an effective way to begin to move the strategy forward? What are some potential short term goals or projects that would bring the right people together, symbolize the larger work ahead and create something achievable that lays the ground work for the next step?

Step 9. Evaluation: How do we tell if it's working?

Meanwhile, the process needs to be checked. Strategy needs to be evaluated by revisiting each of the steps explained above.

Activity

Develop an advocacy strategy to advocate for a right of your choice.

Teacher's Note

Help students and divide them in groups of 2-3 students and direct them to plan a series of organized and consecutive actions to be taken to advocate for right of their choice for documenting an advocacy strategy.

SUMMARY

In this chapter, you studied that a person who is a legally recognized resident of a particular country is a citizen. You were introduced with the various rights that people have. Rights have also some limitations and people should respect other's rights. Advocacy is the act of pleading for, supporting, or recommending and an active support for most vulnerable people.

END OF THE CHAPTER EXERCISE

Check your knowledge and understanding

Fill in the blanks

- The civil rights are mainly associated with the life and _____ of a citizen.
- The Article 25-A of the Constitution provides for _____ to all children of age five (5) to sixteen (16).
- The fundamental rights promote better life, _____ and _____.

Answer the following questions

- What type of rights citizens enjoy in a country?
- What are the responsibilities of a citizen?
- Why rights have limits?
- Describe reasons to communicate with elected officials of your area?
- Describe process of developing an advocacy strategy?
- Identify two advocacy strategies that you know and give examples of how they are used?

Use Your Inquiry/ Investigation Skills

Explore the rights enjoyed by the citizens of any one of the following countries:

Sr. No	U.S.A	U.K	China

SLOs:

- Define the term civil society.
- Identify various Civil society organizations (CSOs) and the work each does in your neighborhood community, nationally and globally.
- Categorize CSOs based on their work.
- Identify the role and functions of CSOs.
- Identify what motivates people to join a CSO and work together for a cause.
- Explain the role of CSOs in contributing to the welfare of the people.
- Identify those factors which create the need for CSOs.
- Describe how CSOs promote rights and strengthen democracy.
- Inquire into a CSO of your choice identifying its goals and objectives, activities it engages in to realize its objectives and assess its impact. Share findings with your colleagues.
- List the work CSOs have done to enhance the democratic culture in Pakistan.
- Name CSOs that are formed by children (eg. scouts, girl guides, youth assembly of Pakistan).
- Define the term volunteer.
- Explain how volunteerism in a society facilitates the welfare of the common people.
- Identify the extent to which young people volunteer their time and expertise in Pakistan.
- Identify three things that can be done to encourage volunteerism in Pakistan.

Introduction

In this chapter, you will study about the civil society and its role in the betterment of society. You will also be introduced about the civil society organisations, its functions and roles towards enhancing democratic culture in Pakistan. Moreover, you will also be introduced in detail with the concept of volunteerism.

What is Civil Society?

It is an organization founded to promote the interests of a local community. The term "civil society" generally is used to refer to social relations and organizations outside the state or governmental control. A civil society is comprised of groups or organizations working in the interest of the citizens but operating outside of the governmental and for-

profit sectors. Organizations and institutions that make up civil society include labour unions, non-profit organizations and other service agencies that provide an important service to society but generally ask for very little in return.

Activity

Find out about the factors which create the need for Civil Society Organisations. You can take help of your elders in finding out the factors.

Category of Civil Society Organisation

A number of Civil Society Organisations are active in the areas of justice and human rights (economic, social, cultural and political rights). Some of the organisations work on the process of local governance and issues related to decentralizing power, authority and resources at grass root level. Others focus on electoral reforms, administrative reforms and people's access to information.

Functions of Civil Society Organisation (CSO)

The CSOs perform the following functions:

Advocacy: Includes activities such as campaigning, lobbying, direct action, media watch and awareness-raising including public education. Advocacy program is often related to policy issues as organizations and individuals strive to change public policy and practice.

Funding: CSOs offer funds to other organizations in support of democratic governance initiatives and over all socio-economic development.

Legal Assistance: It includes legal assistance to individuals and organizations.

Networking: It is related to developing and strengthening communication and exchange systems between organizations and (or) individuals.

Policy: The CSOs are also involved in the process of setting objectives and formulation of specific policies. They also make an active plan to execute these policies.

Research: The CSOs also encourage researchers to conduct research on specific issues which affect the communities.

Technical Assistance: The CSOs also provide consultancy and technical assistance for handling different problems identified by other organizations.

Training: Includes activities designed to strengthen specific knowledge and skills of individuals. Training methods used include workshops, conferences and short courses. There is a wide range of areas such as voter education, methods to encourage greater participation of women in political processes, as well as training in new technologies.

Many of these organizations are involved in advocating for the strengthening of policies and practices that promote democracy. Their activities include provision of support to strengthen the civil society sector, promotion of citizen's rights and people's involvement in democratic processes, enhancement of women's participation in politics and fostering political dialogue.

Activity

Make a list of various civil society organizations (CSOs) that work in your country: local, national and international. Take help from Newspapers, internet, parents and any other available source.

Role of Civil Society Organisations in a Democratic Country

- The basic role of civil society is to limit and control the power of the state.
- Civil society actors should watch how state officials use their powers. They should raise public concern about any abuse of power.
- Civil society promotes political participation.
- Civil society organizations can help to develop the other values of democratic life: tolerance, moderation, compromise, and respect for other's opinion.
- Civil society can also help to develop programs for democratic civic education in the schools as well.
- Civil society is a platform for the expression of diverse interests.
- Civil society can strengthen democracy through process of integrating different communities in society.
- Civil society can provide a training ground for future political leaders.
- Civil society can help to inform the public about important public issues.
- Civil society organizations can play an important role in mediating and helping to resolve conflict.
- Civil society organizations have a vital role to play in monitoring the conduct of elections.

Activity

Work together in groups and discuss how Civil Society Organisations promote rights and strengthen democracy.

The Volunteers

The person who works for an organization without being paid is called volunteer. The concept of volunteering refers to –rendering services by choice for the benefit of the wider community by an individual, group or institution without necessarily expecting monetary gain.

Volunteering: Building A Better Community

You can be a volunteer by taking an active part in making your area a better place to live in. You give something back to your community. And when you give something back, you will also get something in return. You get the rewards that come from making a positive difference in the lives of others in your community.

Contribution of Volunteers for the welfare of the common people

- Volunteering makes a significant contribution to the global economy.
- Volunteering enhances the social connections between different sectors and builds the bridges between governments and states.
- Volunteering helps to build a more cohesive, safer, stronger community and increase the social networking between communities and neighborhood.
- Volunteering promotes active citizenship and greater participation of people in social development.
- Volunteering helps to improve educational standards of youth and helps to reduce the environmental risks.
- Volunteering also have positive effects on volunteers. It increase their self-esteem, enhance various skills and capacities, increase their motivation for helping others.

Activity

Conduct an interview of volunteers to find out to what extent they have been able to volunteer their time and expertise in Pakistan.

SUMMARY

In this chapter, you studied that a civil society is comprised of groups or organizations working in the interest of the citizens. A large number of CSOs are actively involved in the broad areas of justice and human rights (economic, social, cultural and political rights). You were able to learn that CSOs perform various functions including advocacy, funding, legal assistance, networking, policy, research, technical assistance and training. Civil society not only monitors the performance of various sectors of governance but it also promotes positive relationship between the democratic state and its citizens. You also studied that the person who works for an organization without being paid is called volunteer. Volunteering makes a momentous contribution to the large-scale economy.

END OF THE CHAPTER EXERCISE

Check your knowledge and understanding

Fill in the Blanks

- i. The person who works for an organization without being paid is called _____.
- ii. Basic role of civil society is to limit and control the power of the _____.
- iii. The volunteer sector plays a key role in _____.
- iv. Civil society can provide a training ground for future political _____.

Answer the following questions

- I. Identify the role and functions of CSOs.
- II. Identify what motivates people to join a CSO and work together for a cause?
- III. Explain the role of CSOs in contributing to the welfare of the people.
- IV. Identify three things that can be done to encourage volunteerism in Pakistan.

Cooperate With Others

Work together in groups. Some groups should work on the task "A", while others should work on the task "B". Then, share information in the class by giving Presentation.

Task

- (A) Write the name of CSOs that are formed by children (eg. scouts, girl guides and youth assembly of Pakistan).
- (B) List the work CSOs have done to enhance the democratic culture in Pakistan.

Name of Civil Society organization	Services / Works
Scouts	
Girl Guide	
Youth Assembly of Pakistan	

Use your Inquiry/ Investigation Skills

Inquire into a CSO of your choice and identify its goals, objectives and activities it engages in order to realize its objectives and assess its impact. Share findings with your colleagues.